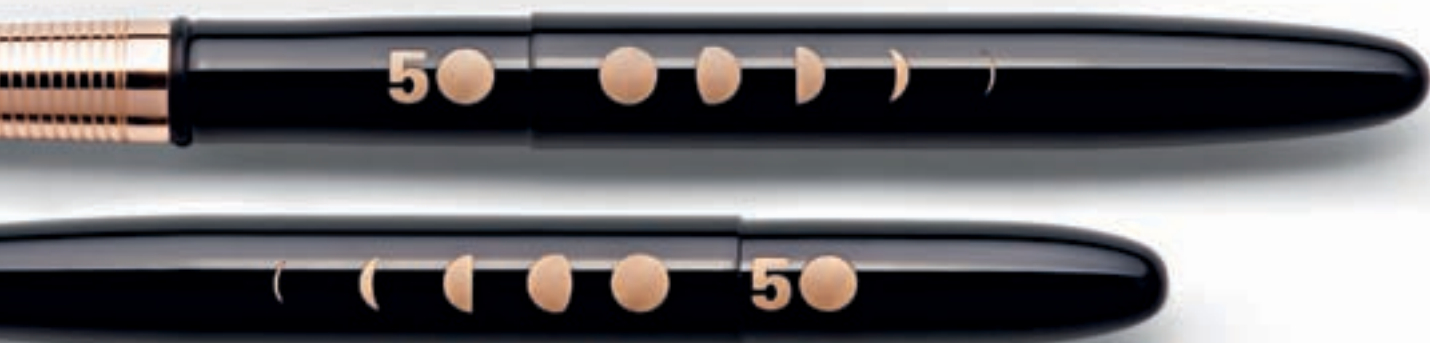




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1. The Fisher Bullet Space Pen has a place in the permanent collection of the New York Museum of Modern Art

2. Called the 'Montblanc High Artistry The First Ascent of the Mont Blanc' collection, these limited edition pens pay tribute to the first ascent of Western Europe's highest peak. Priced at €1.5 million, the pen has a solid white gold cap bejewelled with alternating ribbons of diamonds and sapphires to represent icy mountains



designed like a Viking complete with headgear, beard and armour while the barrel makes the legs. There is also a detachable sword.

While the European writing instrument manufacturers are known for their aesthetic appeal, it was Paul Fisher, an American who first realised when man started to explore outer space, that there was no existing writing instrument that could function successfully (and safely) in zero gravity. After much research, he came up with what we today know as the Fisher Space Pen, which was used by NASA astronauts in 1967. Since then, millions have used the pen which, thanks to its pressurised solid ink technology, doesn't leak and writes reliably on difficult surfaces, including underwater. If you are looking at doing crossword in bed, pick up any regular Fisher Space Pen (they work upside down too) but if it's a piece of history you are interested in, go for the limited edition pens launched on the 50th anniversary of the 1969 Apollo 11 mission. Limited to only 500 pieces, the AG-7 Space Pens feature a genuine, authenticated material from the Apollo 11 spacecraft and are priced at \$750 (₹61,365). Then there is also the Fisher Bullet Space Pen, one of the company's most popular pens that has a place in the permanent collection of the New

York Museum of Modern Art.

A favourite of US Presidents, A. T. Cross is one of the oldest pen makers in the world, founded in 1846. George H.W. Bush, George Bush and Barack Obama—all preferred various Cross pens. In a break from tradition, the inimitable Donald Trump opted for the humble Sharpie. Current US President Joe Biden began his tenure by signing 17 executive orders, with his pen of choice by A. T. Cross. Over the years, different Presidents have used not one but several pens to sign important orders and then handed them out to staff as historical artefacts. While Cross fountain pens are available at \$25-\$200, some limited edition ones can cost a lot more. For instance, the limited edition launched to celebrate the company's 170th anniversary in solid gold finish and restricted to 170 pieces was priced upwards of \$5,000 (₹4 lakh).

There is something special about putting pen to paper, no matter how much you may wave your stylus. Little wonder the luxury pens market is growing at a CAGR of 5 per cent and is expected to be worth \$3.27 billion by 2028 from \$2.33 billion in 2021, according to a report by The Insight Partners, a market research firm. **BT**

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